ROMERO NYC MARKETING AGENCY LLC PRESENTS

THE ICP EXCAVATION WORKBOOK.

Find your actual best-fit customer. Not the one you think it is.

A structured framework for identifying, scoring, and tiering your ideal customer profile. Includes customer interview templates, signal scoring, a three-tier classification system, and the questions most founders have never asked about their own best clients.

Customer Interviews · Signal Scoring · ICP Tiering · Launch-Ready Profile

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01

Why Most ICPs Are Wrong

The customer you think you serve and the customer you actually serve best are rarely the same person.

Most companies build their ICP from aspiration, not evidence. They describe the customer they want, not the customer who actually buys, stays, and refers others. The result is outbound that targets the wrong people, messaging that misses, and meetings that do not convert.

This workbook excavates your real ICP through structured reflection on your actual client history. The process takes 2 to 4 hours. The output is a concrete, evidence-based profile you can hand directly to an outbound team and say: find me more of these.

THE CORE INSIGHT	Your best clients tell you more about your ICP than any market research ever will. The data already exists. You just have not organized it yet.

The Five Signs Your ICP Is Wrong

You have churned clients who matched your stated ICP

If your target profile is churning, you are targeting the wrong signals.

Your best clients came from unexpected places

Unexpected wins contain your real ICP. Analyze them, do not dismiss them.

Your sales cycle varies wildly by segment

Inconsistency signals you are selling to fundamentally different buyers.

Your messaging resonates with some ICPs but not others

The segment that responds immediately is telling you something important.

You cannot describe your best client in one sentence

If you need three caveats to define your ICP, you do not have one yet.

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02

Step 1: Mine Your Best Clients

Before you build your ICP, identify the raw material. Your best clients are the answer.

Go through your entire client history. For each client, score them across four dimensions. The clients who score highest are your ICP seeds. Do not filter by who you want to target. Filter by who has actually performed.

The Four Dimensions of a High-Value Client

- **Revenue quality:** High ACV, clean contracts, minimal discounting, on-time payment.
- **Retention:** Long relationships, low churn, expanding contracts over time.
- **Referrability:** They refer others, leave reviews, and act as case study subjects.
- **Speed to value:** They onboarded fast, saw results early, required minimal hand-holding.

Client Inventory Table

List your top 10 to 15 clients below. Score each 1 to 5 on every dimension.

Client / Company	Industry	Revenue Quality (1-5)	Retention (1-5)	Referrability (1-5)	Speed (1-5)	TOTAL
_____	___	___	___	___	___	___
_____	___	___	___	___	___	___
_____	___	___	___	___	___	___
_____	___	___	___	___	___	___
_____	___	___	___	___	___	___
_____	___	___	___	___	___	___
_____	___	___	___	___	___	___
_____	___	___	___	___	___	___
_____	___	___	___	___	___	___
_____	___	___	___	___	___	___

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After scoring: which 3 to 5 clients have the highest totals? List them here.

These are your ICP seeds. The next section excavates what makes them similar.

03

Step 2: The Client Interview Template

Talk to your best clients. Their words are your most valuable marketing asset.

Schedule 20-minute calls with your top 3 to 5 clients. Tell them you are doing research to serve clients like them better, not a sales call. Use the questions below. Record the call if they permit. The goal is to hear their words, not confirm your assumptions.

BEFORE YOU START	Do not lead with your value proposition. Do not ask if they like you. Ask open questions and listen. The most valuable answers are often to questions you did not plan to ask.

Section A: Before They Found You

Q1 What was the problem you were trying to solve when you first looked for a solution like ours?

Probe: What words did they use? What did they Google? This is your copy.

Q2 How long had this been a problem before you acted on it?

Probe: Urgency triggers reveal what finally moved them from awareness to action.

Q3 What solutions had you already tried before us?

Probe: Competitors and alternatives they considered. Why those failed.

Q4 Who else was involved in the decision to move forward?

Probe: Buying committee, internal champions, blockers. Maps the real sales process.

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Section B: The Decision

Q5 What was the main reason you chose us over the alternatives?

Probe: Their answer is your actual differentiator. Not the one on your website.

Q6 Was there a moment you almost did not move forward? What almost stopped you?

Probe: Objections they overcame. Gold for your outbound copy.

Q7 What would have had to be true for you to say no?

Probe: Reverse-engineers your disqualifiers from the buyer perspective.

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Section C: After the Decision

Q8 What has changed in your business since working with us?

Probe: The outcome in their words. Use this in your outbound subject lines and body copy.

Q9 Have you recommended us to anyone? What did you say?

Probe: Their referral language is your most potent messaging. Write it down verbatim.

Q10 If you were describing us to a peer, how would you explain what we do?

Probe: How they categorize you. Often different from how you describe yourself.

Section D: Pattern Recognition (complete after all interviews)

What words or phrases appeared in multiple interviews? (List verbatim)

These become your subject lines, email openers, and positioning language.

What trigger event preceded the decision in most cases?

e.g., new funding, hiring surge, leadership change, missed target

What was the single most common "before" pain state?

The problem they described in their own words before finding you.

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Step 3: Signal Scoring Framework

Not all ICP criteria are equal. Score each signal by predictive power, not by preference.

Review each attribute below. Score it 1 to 5 based on how strongly it predicts a high-value client outcome in your business. A score of 5 means this signal alone is nearly sufficient to predict a strong client. A score of 1 means it is present in your best and worst clients equally.

HOW TO USE THIS

Complete this table after reviewing your client inventory and interviews. The highest-scoring signals become your targeting criteria. Signals scoring 1 or 2 should be removed from your ICP definition entirely.

Firmographic Signals

Attribute	Score (1 to 5)	Why It Matters / Notes
Industry or vertical	1 2 3 4 5 circle one	_____
Company size (employees)	1 2 3 4 5 circle one	_____
Company size (revenue)	1 2 3 4 5 circle one	_____
Geography or market	1 2 3 4 5 circle one	_____
Business model (B2B vs B2C vs marketplace)	1 2 3 4 5 circle one	_____
Funding stage or ownership type	1 2 3 4 5 circle one	_____
Years in business	1 2 3 4 5 circle one	_____

Behavioral and Trigger Signals

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Attribute	Score (1 to 5)	Why It Matters / Notes
Recent hiring in a specific function	1 2 3 4 5 circle one	_____
Recent funding round	1 2 3 4 5 circle one	_____
Recent leadership change	1 2 3 4 5 circle one	_____
Expanding into new markets	1 2 3 4 5 circle one	_____
Launched a new product line	1 2 3 4 5 circle one	_____
Competitor of an existing client	1 2 3 4 5 circle one	_____
Referenced us in their own content	1 2 3 4 5 circle one	_____
Engaged with our outbound previously	1 2 3 4 5 circle one	_____

After scoring: what are your top 3 to 5 signals? (Score 4 or 5)

List the signals you will use as primary targeting criteria for outbound.

What signals did you previously use that scored 1 or 2?

Remove these from your targeting criteria. They are noise, not signal.

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Step 4: The Three-Tier ICP System

Not every prospect deserves the same effort. Tier your ICP so your outbound matches your resources.

Use your signal scoring to classify every prospect into one of three tiers. Tier 1 gets your highest-effort personalized sequences. Tier 2 gets a strong semi-personalized approach. Tier 3 gets low-touch automation or is removed entirely.

TIER 1 · Dream Clients

Score: Signal score 18 to 25

Your highest-value, highest-fit prospects. Every signal aligns. Treat each one as an account.

- Personalized research on each contact before outreach
- Custom email sequence with account-specific references
- Multi-channel: email plus LinkedIn plus phone
- Assign your best copywriting and your fastest follow-up
- Track in CRM individually. Review weekly.

TIER 2 · Strong Fits

Score: Signal score 12 to 17

Most criteria align. One or two signals missing. Worth pursuing with efficient personalization.

- Industry and size signals confirmed
- Semi-personalized sequence with industry-specific language
- Email-first outreach with LinkedIn connection
- Standard 5-step sequence. Prioritize after Tier 1.
- Move to Tier 1 if a trigger event is detected.

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TIER 3 · Possible Fits

Score: Signal score below 12

Partial ICP match. Include only if pipeline pressure demands it.

- Basic personalization only (industry, title)
- Automated sequence with minimal customization
- Lower priority. Pause if response rates drop below 2%.
- Review after 30 days. Promote or remove.

Based on your signal scoring, what is your Tier 1 definition?

Complete the sentence: "Our Tier 1 prospect is a [title] at a [description] company that [trigger/signal]."

Estimated Tier 1 addressable market size:

How many companies fit this definition? Estimate from LinkedIn Sales Nav or Apollo.

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Step 5: Build Your Launch-Ready ICP Profile

Consolidate everything into a single document your outbound team can use on day one.

Complete the fields below. This is the document you hand to your outbound team, your copywriter, and your lead researcher before any campaign launches. It should be specific enough that someone who does not know your business can build an accurate prospect list from it alone.

Company description (one sentence)

e.g., "B2B SaaS companies with 50 to 500 employees and an active outbound sales motion."

Primary industries (ranked by priority)

List in order. Industry 1 gets the most effort. Only list industries with real evidence.

Company size range (employees and revenue)

Be specific. Avoid ranges wider than one order of magnitude.

Geography

Countries, states, or metro areas. Be specific.

Funding stage / ownership

e.g., bootstrapped, Series A to C, PE-backed

Business model

e.g., B2B only, SaaS only, professional services only

Years in business

Minimum age threshold if relevant

Titles we book meetings with (ranked)

Primary title: the one who signs the contract. Secondary: the one who champions internally.

Titles we do NOT book with (add to disqualifiers)

e.g., ICs only, intern titles, non-decision-making roles

Primary trigger event

The single event most likely to precede a purchase decision.

Primary pain state

The problem they describe in their own words.

Secondary trigger events

Additional observable signals worth monitoring.

Desired outcome

What success looks like in their words from your interviews.

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The one-sentence outbound hook (write it here)

Combine trigger event + pain state + outcome. This becomes your email opener template.

Proof points to include in outreach (specific wins)

Client name or industry + result + timeframe. e.g., "Helped a Series B SaaS company book 14 meetings in 30 days."

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07

Common ICP Mistakes

The errors that cause good outbound to land on bad prospects.

1. Defining ICP by aspiration, not evidence

You want to work with Fortune 500 companies. Your best clients are growth-stage firms with 200 employees. Target the latter. Expand later.

2. Making the ICP too broad to be useful

"B2B companies with a sales team" is not an ICP. It is a market. Your ICP should be specific enough to exclude at least 80% of all companies.

3. Treating all signals as equal

Company size and industry are not equally predictive for every business. Score your signals. Prioritize the ones that actually predict high-value clients.

4. Ignoring the buying committee

Your ICP is not just a title. It includes the champion, the decision-maker, and the blockers. Define all three before you write a single email.

5. Never updating the ICP

Your best clients six months from now may look different from your best clients today. Review and update this workbook every quarter. Especially after any significant client win or churn event.

6. Confusing ICP with total addressable market

ICP is not everyone who could theoretically benefit from your product. It is the specific segment where you win most reliably, fastest, and at highest value.

THE FINAL TEST	Hand your completed ICP profile to someone who does not know your business. Ask them to build a list of 50 prospects from it using LinkedIn Sales Navigator. If they cannot do it without asking you clarifying questions, your ICP is not specific enough yet.

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ABOUT

Romero NYC Marketing Agency LLC

We book the meetings. You close the deals.

Romero NYC runs AI-powered outbound email campaigns for B2B companies ready to scale. We manage the entire outbound process, from list building and domain infrastructure to personalized sequences and ongoing optimization.

Our model is simple: you pay only when a qualified prospect appears on your calendar. No retainers. No contracts. No vague metrics. Just meetings with people who match your exact ICP, within 10 to 14 days of launch.

Who We Work With

B2B companies where a single client is worth $10,000 or more.

What Makes Us Different

◆ **Pay Per Meeting**

Charged only when a confirmed meeting appears on your calendar.

◆ **Zero Upfront Cost**

Full campaign buildout included before you pay a cent.

◆ **14-Day Time to First Meeting**

Most clients see their first meeting within two weeks.

◆ **Full-Stack Done For You**

We handle everything. You just show up to the meetings.

READY TO SCALE?	Book a free 20-minute strategy call at romero.nyc. No pitch deck. No pressure. Just a real conversation.

romero.nyc · book.romero.nyc/20-minute-strategy-call

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